Collate — Product Requirements (v1)

Version 0.1 · 31 Oct 2026 · Owner: Oo Nwoye · Author: Julian Duru · Status: Draft for review

1. Purpose and vision

Collate helps make sure that elections are free and fair. It shows which polling units (PUs) have agents. It lets organizers send messages to those agents. Each user sees and messages only the persons that concern them.

This deployment supports NDC and Peter Obi's presidential campaign for the 2027 elections. A separate, small deployment supports Senator Natasha's local government election.

Design principle from Oo: "the genius is in making it simple".

2. Problems

1. Candidates and agents reach the campaign through personal phones and WhatsApp. Nobody can message one defined set of people.
2. Nobody can see which of the 176,846 PUs have an agent.

3. Users and groups

Category	**Who**
Admin	Oo, Julian, volunteers, Dubem. Admins have permission levels. Oo and Julian have the highest level.
User: party	NDC at national, state and lower levels
User: campaign	Two presidential campaigns: one from the party, one from Peter Obi's own structure
User: support group	Obedient Movement, Kwankwasiyya, OK Movement (Obi–Kwankwaso joint venture). Obedient and Kwankwasiyya did not merge. Each keeps its own hierarchy.
User: candidate	President, Governor, Senate, House of Reps, State Assembly. Running mates get the view,

Category	Who
	rights and messages of their principal (decided 28 Oct).
Agent	Every registered person, admins and candidates included, at a PU in their own ward. Agents receive messages only and do not log in.

Admins create and change groups. NDC is a master group. Each group has levels, for example one user per state.

4. Visibility rules

1. Admins see and message all persons. Each other user sees only their scope.
2. Tree rule (decided 28 Oct): A is below B when A has a lower office and an area that overlaps B, also partly. Use the PU-to-political-unit mapping, not office titles.
3. Party users and candidates use the same permission model (Oo's proposal). Example: the NDC Lagos chair and the Lagos governorship candidate see all groups' agents in Lagos only.
4. In v1, each group sees all agents in its scope. Later, an admin must be able to restrict cross-group visibility without a redesign.
5. Candidates filter by political unit and ward. Only other users can filter by LGA, because an LGA can cross several candidate areas.
6. A user who can message a PU can message all agents at that PU (decided 28 Oct).
7. Messages go only down the tree.

5. Coverage rules

1. Headline coverage counts PUs with an official agent (decided 28 Oct). Format: "6,265 of 13,325 (47%)".
2. Each other agent at a PU is an extra agent. Its owner is the group or candidate that registered it. Extra agents never change headline coverage.
3. Each group sees its own coverage: the PUs where it has at least one agent. Users can compare groups side by side and see combined coverage. One PU can have six or seven agents.
4. Each PU has one official slot by default. Extra slots get the numbers `/1`, `/2`, `/3`. An empty slot shows a placeholder, for example "Agent – 04-17-03-012 /1".
5. Each PU shows all offices at stake there. An empty office shows "Nil" and one reason: no election there in 2027 (off-cycle state), no NDC candidate, or INEC data missing.

6. To confirm: Electoral Act 2026 s.42/44 can give each candidate an own official agent (3 per PU on 16 January, 2 on the second day). Then the product must count headline coverage per candidate.

6. v1 features

Each bullet is an acceptance criterion.

1. **Home dashboard.**
    - After login, the user sees a short summary: Coverage, Messages, People. A first-time user also sees a short welcome.
2. **Coverage** (the main view).
    - Views by administrative unit, by political unit and by candidate.
    - The map shows GRID3 outlines (CC BY 4.0) down to ward level. A PU with GPS outside its LGA shows "position doubtful".
    - A click on a PU opens a side panel with its agents (official first, then extras with owner tags) and candidates at stake.
    - The "no agent" filter shows the gaps. The group-coverage view compares groups.
3. **Candidates.**
    - Columns: Office, Seat, Candidate, Coverage, View as. The user can sort by coverage.
    - Running mates show below their principal.
    - "+N extra agents of their own" opens the list.
4. **Agents and people.**
    - Each PU has one row: the official agent, then the extras.
    - Filters: gaps, PUs with extras, owner.
    - The user can import CSV or Excel lists. The import removes duplicates by phone number. If lists conflict, the list from the candidate wins.
5. **Messaging (send only).**
    - The broadcast wizard has three steps: audience, message, schedule.
    - Filters: office and unit. The counts show official and extra agents separately.
    - Each message has an OK button. Each recipient shows one status: sent, delivered, delivered by SMS, failed, tapped OK.
    - Prefilled gap message: "These are the PUs in your area with no agent".
6. **Candidate access links.**
    - Admins send candidates personal links to their own views, in bulk. Admins can revoke and reissue links.
    - Each link has an expiry date and an access log. Each deployment selects if links need OTP.
7. **Admin settings.**
    - Admins manage groups, users, candidate links, the audit log and channels. Admins can "View as" any role.

7. Onboarding, channel and identity

Onboarding (Recommended, 31 Oct):

- Users get an invitation. Collate has no public sign-up page, because the agent data must stay secret.
- Admins invite the top users. Each user can invite users below them, only in their own scope and only at a lower level (the tree rule in section 4).
- The inviter enters the name, phone number, group, role and scope units. The invitee opens the invitation link, logs in with an OTP to that phone number and accepts the consent text.
- At the first login, the user adds their home PU and, optionally, an email address.
- Candidates do not sign up. Admins load them from the candidate list and send them access links (section 6).
- Agents do not sign up. Agents come from the imported lists (name, phone number, PU, owner) and connect through the Telegram bot.

Channel and identity (decided 26 Oct):

- Collate uses a Telegram bot. Each person opens a bot link and taps "share my number".
- Only persons on the uploaded registered list get messages. The bot matches by phone number.
- A person can have more than one phone number. Collate adds a new Telegram number only after the person confirms it through their listed number.
- SMS is the fallback. SMS needs a sender ID on all four networks.

8. Data protection (decided 26 Oct)

- Party affiliation is sensitive personal data under NDPA 2023 s.30. Get consent at registration that also covers data transfer to the party (s.30(1)(a)).
- Do a DPIA (s.28). Secure the data (s.39).
- The Telegram bot terms need a published privacy policy and encrypted stored data.
- Agents must stay secret before election day. Collate must have role-scoped access, an audit log and masked phone numbers. Candidates must not get bulk export.

9. Out of scope

- Inbound messages and replies other than OK (a later plug-in).
- Payments to agents (a future idea from Oo).
- Election-day check-in, result upload, unofficial-agent tags and agent training.
- Messages to voters, upward or sideways messages, and other parties on this deployment.

- Native mobile apps. v1 is a web app that also works on phones.

10. Success measures

Measure	**Target**
Share of PUs with an official agent	Not decided. Baseline unknown.
Share of NDC candidates reachable on the platform	Not decided
Delivery rate per broadcast	Not decided
Demo to campaign leadership	To confirm: date

11. Risks

Risk	**Mitigation**
Agents become known before election day	The controls in section 8
Meta bars political campaigns from the WhatsApp Business API	Telegram, with SMS as the fallback
No SMS sender ID	Telegram stays primary.

12. Open items

The architecture document lists the technical open items.

1. Not decided: cross-group visibility rules.
2. To confirm: legal interpretation of Electoral Act s.42/44.
3. To confirm: offices on the first election day. The in-repo PRD and Oo (31 Oct) give different lists.
4. Not decided: role of Danladi Retzam.
5. To confirm: MVP date, and if the MVP contains all seven v1 features. The in-repo PRD gives about 2 November.
6. To confirm: invitation-only onboarding (section 7), and if users must give a PVC number.

13. Glossary

Term	**Meaning**
Political unit	The area of an elected seat. It can cross LGA borders.
Seat	One office in one political unit, for example "Senate, Anambra North"
Official agent	The one party agent at a PU that INEC recognizes. It stands for all NDC candidates there.
Scope	The set of PUs that a user can see and message